

There are a number of Linux distributions on hand for Raspberry Pi 1 and 2, but the community always wants more. There are some very good technical reasons why we won't see Ubuntu or Kubuntu running on a Raspberry Pi shortly, but those reasons don't apply to all the official flavours.

The developers are setting an example in this regard, and it looks like they already managed to release one of the best distros for this mini PC. The tools are already under production, and anyone interested can download the source package for it, but please keep in mind that they still need to be enhanced. In any case, if things go well, we should see a series of new distros for Raspberry Pi 2 soon.



In the meantime, you can download the Ubuntu MATE 15.10 for the Raspberry Pi distribution from the authorised servers.

Netflix updates its open source policies

Video-streamer and entertainment production house, Netflix has restructured its open source policies. One remarkable change is a decision to release code pre-packaged in Docker's container formats.



Netflix has open sourced a lot of its production code, but now says those efforts were puzzling some because it was getting harder to figure out which projects were useful for a particular company or a team. "The external community was also uncertain about which components Netflix continued

to put in and support, and which were in maintenance or sunset mode," developers reported.

A revival of the company's GitHub outpost is among its other developer-friendly efforts, which include a pledge to do the four following things from now on:

- It will provide full transparency on which projects are archived, i.e., no longer actively developed or maintained. It will not be removing any code from GitHub repos, but will articulate if the company is no longer actively developing or using a particular project. This will affect and reflect on its OSS projects as Netflix needs to change over time.
- Offer an enhanced roadmap for what new projects the company is planning to open, and which open projects are still in a state of heavy change. This will allow the community to better decide whether particular projects are appealing.
- Expose some of the internal metrics Netflix uses to evaluate its OSS projects - number of issues, commits, etc. This will provide better transparency regarding the maturity/velocity of each project.
- Docker is gradually becoming more accepted and Netflix is a prominent company, so the decision to Dockerise could well create ripples and additionally, move forward the container platform's popularity and reach – if at all that's possible, given that Microsoft, VMware, OpenStack and many others have all decided that Docker's an impressive way to do containers.

Neo4j unveils graph query language called openCypher

The Neo4j graph NoSQL database team has unveiled an open source graph query language called openCypher. Neo Technology announced the launch of the open source project, which will be accessible to technology providers as a common language for querying graph data. It is based on Neo4j's query language that is used to accumulate and recover data in the graph database. At present, there is no common query language standard for working with graph databases, like SQL for accessing data in relational databases.

The objective of openCypher is to speed up the growth of graph processing and analysis. Technology providers can implement openCypher inside their tools and platforms. It delivers four major artifacts under a permissive licence:

Language specification: The Cypher language specification is a technical expression of the language syntax to enable parsers to auto-generate the query syntax. A full semantic specification is also planned as a part of the openCypher project.

Reference implementation: Distributed under the Apache 2.0 License, reference implementation is a fully functional implementation of key parts of the stack needed to support Cypher inside a data platform or tool. The first planned deliverable is a parser that will take a Cypher statement and parse it into an abstract syntax tree representation.

Technology compatibility kit (TCK): This consists of tests that software vendors can run on their products, to self-certify support for a given version of Cypher.

Cypher reference documentation: This includes the user documentation describing the use of the Cypher query language with examples and tutorials.

A number of organisations are supporting the openCypher project and these include Oracle, Databricks, Tableau and Linkurious.

You can learn more about openCypher by going on the website's FAQ page.